

PICTURE THIS!

A Playful Photo Moment

Level 2-4
15-30 minutes

Wellness Domains

Social / Emotional

Topic:

Play, Self-Expression & Being Seen

Goals:

Develop a positive self-image

Materials (Included/Subs):

- Camera / phone camera
- Music
- Background - bed sheet, green screen, step-and-repeat, or a nice location for background
- Props - sunglasses, fancy dress, hats, masquerade masks, scarves, jewelry, fairy wings, flowers, crown, confetti
- Optional: printing photos

Background:

This activity is a playful photo shoot meant to lift the mood and invite self-expression. It is not about looking perfect. It is about having fun, trying something new, and being seen in a positive light!

The participant can choose how they want to look, pose, and interact. Silly, proud, dramatic, or simple are all welcome. Laughter, joy and creativity are part of the goal. Photos can be kept private, shared with family, or used just for the moment. *Sharing is always optional.*

Structure / Activity:

Steps

1. Set a fun tone - music, lighting, room setup. Smile and explain that this is a photography activity. They're the muse!
2. Offer choices for props, outfits, or backgrounds. Let the participant choose what feels fun. Allow costume changes if so desired.
3. Ask how they want to pose. Demonstrate ideas if helpful (hands on hips, waving, laughing).
4. Take a few photos at a relaxed pace. Pause between shots to show the photos if they want.
5. Encourage play. Try one "serious" photo and one silly or creative photo.
6. Let the participant choose their favorite picture.
7. Ask if they would like the photo saved, shared, or just enjoyed in the moment.
8. End by thanking them and naming something positive you noticed.

Prompt Ideas (Use What Fits):

- Big smile
- Hands on hips / power pose
- Wave hello
- Play with your hair
- "Model pose"

Themes:

- Goddess
- Queen / King
- Feeling calm, strong, playful, joyful
- Creative Twists
- Funny face photo
- "Magazine cover" pose
- Superhero
- Biggest laugh / clown

Adaptations & Safety Precautions:

- Participation is always voluntary
- Do not pressure smiling or posing
- Stop if the participant becomes uncomfortable or overstimulated
- Photos are only taken and shared with permission
- Respect privacy and dignity at all times
- Avoid teasing or joking about appearance

For Higher Energy or Ability:

- Let them direct the shoot
- Invite storytelling ("What's happening in this photo?")

For Sensory Sensitivities:

- Avoid flash
- Keep lighting and music soft